

Munich

Munich^[a] (German: *München* [ˈmʏnçn̩] [ⓘ], Bavarian: *Minga* [ˈmɪŋ(ː)ɐ] [ⓘ]) is the capital and most populous city of Bavaria, Germany. As of 30 November 2024, its population was 1,604,384,^[3] making it the third-largest city in Germany after Berlin and Hamburg. Munich is the largest city in Germany that is not a state of its own, and it ranks as the 11th-largest city in the European Union (EU). The metropolitan area has around 3 million inhabitants, and the broader Munich Metropolitan Region is home to about 6.2 million people.^[4] It is the third largest metropolitan region by GDP in the EU. Munich is located on the river Isar north of the Alps. It is the seat of the Upper Bavarian administrative region. With 4,500 people per km², Munich is Germany's most densely populated municipality. It is also the second-largest city in the Bavarian dialect area after Vienna.

The first record of Munich dates to 1158. The city has played an important role in Bavarian and German history. During the Reformation, it remained a Catholic stronghold. Munich became the capital of the Kingdom of Bavaria in 1806 and developed as a centre for arts, architecture, culture, and science. The House of Wittelsbach ruled until 1918, when the German revolution of 1918–1919 ended their reign and saw the short-lived Bavarian Soviet Republic. In the 1920s, Munich became a centre of political movements, including the rise of the Nazi Party. The city was known as the "Capital of the Movement". During World War II, Munich was heavily bombed, but much of its historic architecture has since been restored.^{[5][6]} After the war, the city's population and economy grew rapidly. Munich hosted the 1972 Summer Olympics and the 1974 FIFA World Cup final.

Munich is a major centre for science, technology, finance, innovation, business, and tourism. It has a high standard of living, ranking first in Germany and third worldwide in the 2018 Mercer survey.^[7] It was named the world's most liveable city by Monocle's Quality of Life Survey 2018.^[8] Munich is the wealthiest city in the EU by GDP per capita among cities with over one million inhabitants^[9] and is among the most expensive German cities for real estate and rents.^{[10][11]} In 2023, 30.1% of residents were foreigners, and 19.4% were German citizens with a migration background from abroad.^[12] Munich's economy is based on high tech, automobiles, the service sector, information technology, biotechnology,

Munich

München (German)

Minga (Bavarian)

City



Marienplatz with Neues Rathaus and Frauenkirche in the background



Maximilianeum



Nymphenburg Palace



Maximilianstraße



Talburgtor



Theatine Church



Munich Residenz



BMW Welt



Flag



Coat of arms

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Munich#Public_transport

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engineering, and electronics. Multinational companies such as BMW, Siemens, Allianz SE, and Munich Re are headquartered there. The city has two research universities and many scientific institutions.^[13] Munich is known for its architecture, cultural venues, sports events, exhibitions, and the annual Oktoberfest, the world's largest *Volksfest*.^[14]

History

Etymology

Munich was a tiny 12th-century monastic settlement, which was named *zu den Munchen* ("to the monks"). The Old High German *Munche* served as the base for the modern German city name *München*.^[15]

Early history

The river Isar was a prehistoric trade route and in the Bronze Age Munich was among the largest raft ports in Europe.^[16] Bronze Age settlements up to four millennia old have been discovered.^[17] Evidence of Celtic settlements from the Iron Age have been discovered in areas around Ramersdorf-Perlach.^[18]

The ancient Roman road Via Julia, which connected Augsburg and Salzburg, crossed over the Isar south of Munich, at the towns of Baierbrunn and Gauting.^[19] A Roman settlement north-east of Munich was excavated in the neighborhood of Denning.^[20]

Starting in the 6th century, the Baiuvarii populated the area around what is now modern Munich, such as in Johanneskirchen, Feldmoching, Bogenhausen and Pasing.^[21]^[22] The first known Christian church was built ca. 815 in Fröttmanning.^[23]

Middle Ages



Munich in a 1493 woodcut from Hartmann Schedel's *Nuremberg Chronicle*



Location of Munich



- Show map of Germany
- Show map of Bavaria
- Show both

Coordinates: 48°08′15″N 11°34′30″E

Country	 Germany
State	 Bavaria
Admin. region	Upper Bavaria
District	Urban district
First mentioned	1158
Subdivisions	25 boroughs
Government • Lord mayor (2026–32)	 Dominik Krause (Greens)
 • Governing parties	 Greens / SPD
Area • City	310.71 km ² (119.97 sq mi)
Elevation	520 m (1,710 ft)
Population (2024-12-31) ^[1] • City • Density • Urban • Metro	1,505,005 • 4,843.8/km ² (12,545/sq mi) • 2,606,021 • 5,991,144 ^[2]
Time zone • Summer (DST)	UTC+01:00 (CET) • UTC+02:00 (CEST)

The first medieval bridges across the river Isar were located in current city areas of Munich and Landshut.^[16] Henry the Lion, the Duke of Saxony and Bavaria, founded the town of Munich in his territory to control the salt trade, after having burned down the town of Föhring and its bridges over the Isar.^[24] Historians date this event at about 1158.^{[25]:167}

Postal codes	80331–81929
Dialling codes	089
Vehicle registration	M, MUC
Website	stadt.muenchen.de (https://stadt.muenchen.de/en/rathaus.html)

Henry built a new toll bridge, customs house and a coin market closer to his home, somewhat upstream, at a settlement around the area of modern old town Munich. This new toll bridge most likely crossed the Isar where the Museuminsel and the modern Ludwigsbrücke are now located.^[26]

Otto of Freising protested to his nephew, Emperor Frederick Barbarossa. However, on 14 June 1158, in Augsburg, the conflict was settled in favor of Duke Henry. The *Augsburg Arbitration* mentions the name of the location in dispute as *forum apud Munichen*. Although Bishop Otto had lost his bridge, the arbiters ordered Duke Henry to pay a third of his income to the Bishop in Freising as compensation.^{[27][28][29]}

14 June 1158 is considered the official founding day of the city of Munich. Archaeological excavations at Marienhof Square (near Marienplatz) in advance of the expansion of the S-Bahn (subway) in 2012 discovered shards of vessels from the 11th century, which prove again that the settlement of Munich must be older than the Augsburg Arbitration of 1158.^{[30][31]} The old St. Peter's Church near Marienplatz is also believed to predate the founding date of the town.^[32]

In 1175, Munich received city status and fortification. In 1180, after Henry the Lion's fall from grace with Emperor Frederick Barbarossa, including his trial and exile, Otto I Wittelsbach became Duke of Bavaria, and Munich was handed to the Bishop of Freising. In 1240, Munich was transferred to Otto II Wittelsbach and in 1255, when the Duchy of Bavaria was split in two, Munich became the ducal residence of Upper Bavaria.

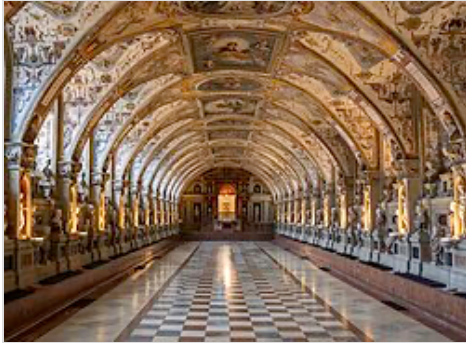
Duke Louis IV, a native of Munich, was elected German king in 1314 and crowned as Holy Roman Emperor in 1328. He strengthened the city's position by granting it the salt monopoly, thus assuring it of additional income.

The growth of Munich was supplemented by its location on top of a gravel bed, where the Isar branched into Munich City Streams, which in turn provided power for many mills and industries within Munich.

In the 15th century, Munich underwent a revival of Gothic arts: the Old Town Hall was enlarged, and Munich's largest Gothic church – the Frauenkirche – now a cathedral, was constructed in only 20 years, starting in 1468.

Capital of reunited Bavaria

When Bavaria was reunited in 1506 after a brief war against the Duchy of Landshut, Munich became its capital. The Renaissance movement beset Munich and the Bavarian branch of the House of Wittelsbach under Duke Albrecht V who bolstered their prestige by conjuring up a lineage that reached back to classical antiquity. In 1568 Albrecht V built the Antiquarium to house the Wittelsbach collection of Greek and Roman antiquities in the Munich Residenz.^[33] Albrecht V appointed the composer Orlando di Lasso as director of the court orchestra and tempted numerous Italian musicians to work at the Munich court, establishing Munich as a hub for late Renaissance music.^[34] During the rule of Duke William V Munich began to be called the "German Rome" and William V began presenting Emperor Charlemagne as ancestor of the Wittelsbach dynasty.^[35]



The Renaissance *Antiquarium* of the Munich Residenz

Duke William V further cemented the Wittelsbach rule by commissioning the Jesuit Michaelskirche. He had the sermons of his Jesuit court preacher Jeremias Drexel translated from Latin into German and published them to a greater audience.^[36] William V was addressed with the epithet "the Pious" and like his contemporary Wittelsbach dukes promoted himself as "father of the land" (*Landesvater*), encouraged pilgrimages and Marian devotions.^[37] William V had the Hofbräuhaus built in 1589. It would become the prototype for beer halls across Munich.

The Catholic League was founded in Munich in 1609. In 1623, during the Thirty Years' War (1618–1648), Munich became an electoral residence when Duke Maximilian I was invested with the electoral

dignity, but in 1632 the city was occupied by King Gustavus Adolphus of Sweden.^[38]

In 1634 Swedish and Spanish troops advanced on Munich. Maximilian I published a plague ordinance to halt an epidemic escalation.^[39] The bubonic plague nevertheless ravaged Munich and the surrounding countryside in 1634 and 1635.^[40] During the Thirty Years' War (1618–1648) troops again converged on Munich in 1647 and precautions were taken, so as to avoid another epidemic.^[41]

Under the regency of the Bavarian electors, Munich was an important centre of Baroque life, but also had to suffer under Habsburg occupations in 1704 and 1742. When Elector Maximilian III Joseph died in 1777, the succession empowered the Palatinate branch within the House of Wittelsbach.^[42]

In 1777, Karl Theodor inherited the Bavarian lands. In 1785, he invited Count Rumford (Benjamin Thompson) to Munich to implement social reforms, including workhouses for the poor and army restructuring with improved conditions for soldiers.^[43] In the 1790s, Munich became the largest German city to remove its fortifications, starting in 1791 under Karl Theodor and Rumford.^[44] After 1793, citizens built new structures outside the former city walls.^[45]



Marienplatz, c. 1650

After making an alliance with Napoleonic France, the city became the capital of the new Kingdom of Bavaria in 1806 with Elector Maximilian IV Joseph becoming its first king. The state parliament (the Landtag) and the new archdiocese of Munich and Freising were also located in the city.^[46]

The establishment of Bavarian state sovereignty made Munich the centre of a modernising kingdom. In 1802, King Maximilian Joseph secularised Bavaria, dissolving monasteries and selling church lands to generate state revenue. He also took control of the right to brew beer, granting a monopoly to Munich's wealthiest brewers in exchange for substantial taxes. In 1807, he abolished restrictions on the number of brewery workers, allowing brewers to meet growing demand.^[47]

In October 1810, a beer festival was held on the meadows outside Munich to celebrate the crown prince's wedding to Princess Therese of Saxe-Hildburghausen. The event, featuring parades in regional dress, later evolved into the annual Oktoberfest, now held at Theresienwiese.^[48]

The first Munich railway station was built in 1839, with a line going to Augsburg in the west. By 1849 a newer Munich Central Train Station (München Hauptbahnhof) was completed, with a line going to Landshut and Regensburg in the north.^{[49][50]} In 1825 Ludwig I had ascended to the throne and commissioned leading



Neoclassical buildings erected under Ludwig I, such as the Propylaea, earned Munich the nickname 'Athens on the Isar'.

architects such as Leo von Klenze to design a series of public museums in neoclassical style. Between 1856 and 1861 the court gardener Carl von Effner landscaped the banks of the river Isar and established the Maximilian Gardens. Leo von Klenze supervised the construction of the Propylaea between 1854 and 1862.^[51] In 1857 the construction of the Maximilianeum was begun.^[52] The grand building projects of Ludwig I gave Munich the endearment "Athens on the Isar" (German: *Isar-Athen*) and "Monaco di Bavaria".^[53]

By the time Ludwig II became king in 1864, he remained mostly aloof from his capital and focused more on his fanciful castles in the Bavarian countryside. In 1876 Munich hosted the first German Art and Industry Exhibition, which showcased the northern Neo-Renaissance fashion that came to be the German Empire's predominant style. Munich based artists put on the German National Applied Arts Exhibition in 1888, showcasing Baroque Revival architecture and Rococo Revival designs.^[54]

The Prince Regent Luitpold's reign from 1886 to 1912 was marked by tremendous artistic and cultural activity in Munich.^[55] At the dawn of the 20th century Munich was an epicenter for the Jugendstil movement, combining a liberal magazine culture with progressive industrial design and architecture. The German art movement took its name from the Munich magazine *Die Jugend* (*The Youth*).^[56] Prominent Munich Jugendstil artists include Hans Eduard von Berlepsch-Valendas, Otto Eckmann,^[57] Margarethe von Brauchitsch, August Endell, Hermann Obrist, Wilhelm von Debschitz,^[58] and Richard Riemerschmid. In 1905 two large department stores opened in Munich, the Kaufhaus Oberpollinger and the Warenhaus Hermann Tietz, both having been designed by the architect Max Littmann.^[59] In 1911 the expressionist group Der Blaue Reiter was established in Munich. Its founding members include Gabriele Münter.^[60]



Jugendstil style house at Leopoldstr. 77. At the beginning of the 20th century, Munich was a hub for the Jugendstil movement.

World War I to World War II

Following the outbreak of World War I in 1914, life in Munich became very difficult, as the Allied blockade of Germany led to food and fuel shortages. During French air raids in 1916, three bombs fell on Munich.

In 1916, the 'Bayerische Motoren Werke' (BMW) produced its first aircraft engine in Munich.^[61] The public limited company BMW AG was founded in 1918, with Camillo Castiglioni owning one third of the share capital. In 1922 BMW relocated its headquarters to a factory in Munich.^[62]

After World War I, the city was at the centre of substantial political unrest. In November 1918, on the eve of the German revolution, Ludwig III of Bavaria and his family fled the city. After the murder of the first republican premier of Bavaria Kurt Eisner in February 1919 by Anton Graf von Arco auf Valley, the Bavarian Soviet Republic was proclaimed.^[63] The November 1918 revolution ended the reign of the Wittelsbach in Bavaria.^[64] In *Mein Kampf* Adolf Hitler described his political activism in Munich after November 1918 as the "Beginning of My Political Activity". Hitler called the short-lived Bavarian Soviet Republic "the rule of the Jews".^[65]

In 1923 Gustav von Kahr was appointed Bavarian prime minister and immediately planned for the expulsion of all Jews who did not hold German citizenship. Chief of Police Ernst Pöhner and Wilhelm Frick openly indulged in antisemitism, while Bavarian judges praised people on the political right as patriotic for their crimes and handed down mild sentences.^[66] In 1923, Adolf Hitler and his supporters, who were concentrated in Munich, staged the Beer Hall Putsch, an attempt to overthrow the Weimar Republic and seize power. The revolt failed, resulting in Hitler's arrest and the temporary crippling of the Nazi Party (NSDAP).^[67]

Munich was chosen as capital for the Free State of Bavaria and acquired increased responsibility for administering the city itself and the surrounding districts. Offices needed to be built for bureaucracy, so a 12-story office building was erected in the southern part of the historic city centre in the late 1920s.^[64]

Munich again became important to the Nazis when they took power in Germany in 1933. The party created its first concentration camp at Dachau, 16 km (10 mi) north-west of the city. Because of its importance to the rise of National Socialism, Munich was referred to as the *Hauptstadt der Bewegung* ("Capital of the Movement").^[68]

The NSDAP headquarters and the documentation apparatus for controlling all aspects of life were located in Munich. Nazi organizations, such as the National Socialist Women's League and the Gestapo, had their offices along Brienner Straße and around the Königsplatz. The party acquired 68 buildings in the area and many *Führerbauten* ("Führer buildings") were built to reflect a new aesthetic of power.^[69] Construction work for the Führerbau and the party headquarters (known as the Brown House) started in September 1933.^[70] The *Haus der Kunst* (House of German Art) was the first building to be commissioned by Hitler. The architect Paul Troost was asked to start work shortly after the Nazis had seized power because "the most German of all German cities" was left with no exhibition building when in 1931 the Glass Palace was destroyed in an arson attack.^[71]

The city was the site where the 1938 Munich Agreement was signed between Nazi Germany, the United Kingdom, France and Italy.^[72] On 8 November 1939, shortly after the Second World War had begun, Georg Elser planted a bomb in the Bürgerbräukeller in Munich in an attempt to assassinate Adolf Hitler, who held a political party speech. Hitler, however, had left the building minutes before the bomb went off.^[73]

During the war, Munich was the location of multiple forced labour camps, including two *Polenlager* camps for Polish youth,^{[74][75]} and 40 subcamps of the Dachau concentration camp, in which men and women of various nationalities were held.^[76] With up to 17,000 prisoners in 1945, the largest subcamp of Dachau was the Munich-Allach concentration camp. By mid 1942 the majority of Jews living in Munich and the suburbs had been deported.^[77]

Munich was the base of the White Rose, a student resistance movement. The core members were arrested and executed after Sophie Scholl and her brother Hans Scholl were caught distributing leaflets on the campus of the Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität München, calling upon the youth to rise against Hitler.^[78]

Around 50 % of city were heavily damaged by the bombing of Munich in World War II, with 71 air raids over five years. After the war, large reconstruction projects restored most of the historically relevant buildings in the old town, that had suffered damage. US troops captured Munich on 30 April 1945.^[79]



Unrest during the 1923 Beer Hall Putsch, a failed coup d'état led by Adolf Hitler, Erich Ludendorff, and other *Kampfbund* leaders

2:43

The unofficial city anthem of Munich, recorded in 1929

Postwar

In the aftermath of World War II, Germany was subject to US Military occupation.^[80] Due to Polish annexation of the former eastern territories of Germany and expulsion of Germans from all over Eastern Europe, Munich operated over a thousand refugee camps for 151,113 people in October 1946.^[81] After US occupation Munich was completely rebuilt following a meticulous plan, which preserved its pre-war street grid, bar a few exceptions owing to then-modern traffic concepts. In 1957, Munich's population surpassed one million. The city continued to play a highly significant role in the West German economy, politics and culture, giving rise to its nickname *Heimliche Hauptstadt* ("secret capital") in the decades after World War II.^[82]

The Free State of Bavaria used the arms industry as kernel for its high tech development policy.^[83] Since 1963, Munich has been hosting the Munich Security Conference, held annually in the Hotel Bayerischer Hof.^[84] Munich also became known on the political level due to the strong influence of Bavarian politician Franz Josef Strauss from the 1960s to the 1980s. The Munich Airport, which commenced operations in 1992, was named in his honor.^[85]

Munich hosted the 1972 Summer Olympics. After winning the bid in 1966 the Mayor of Munich, Hans-Jochen Vogel, accelerated the construction of the U-Bahn subway and the S-Bahn metropolitan commuter railway. In May 1967 the construction work began for a new U-Bahn line connecting the city with the Olympic Park (Olympiapark). The Olympic Park subway station was built near the BMW Headquarters and the line was completed in May 1972, three months before the opening of the 1972 Summer Olympics. Shortly before the opening ceremony, Munich also inaugurated a sizable pedestrian priority zone between Karlsplatz and Marienplatz.^[86] In 1970 the Munich city council released funds so that the gothic facade and Glockenspiel of the New City Hall (Neues Rathaus) could be restored.^[87] During the 1972 Summer Olympics 11 Israeli athletes were murdered by Palestinian terrorists in the Munich massacre, when gunmen from the Palestinian "Black September" group took hostage members of the Israeli Olympic team.^[88] In 1974, the FIFA World Cup final was held at the Olympic Stadium.

Munich and its urban sprawl emerged as the leading German high tech region during the 1980s and 1990s. The urban economy of Munich became characterized by a dynamic labour market, low unemployment, a growing service economy and high per capita income.^[83]

Munich was one of the host cities for the 2006 FIFA World Cup and both the UEFA Euro 2020 – postponed by a year because of the COVID-19 pandemic – and UEFA Euro 2024.^[89]



View of Munich city centre in 1945 after the devastation of World War II, and in 1989 after reconstruction, featuring the restored Old Town Hall, Heilig-Geist-Kirche, and Talburgtor



Olympiapark was the main venue for the 1972 Olympic Games and also hosted the 1974 FIFA World Cup final.

Geography

Topography

Munich lies on the elevated plains of Upper Bavaria, about 50 km (31 mi) north of the northern edge of the Alps, at an altitude of about 520 m (1,706 ft) ASL. The local rivers are the Isar and the Würm. Munich is situated in the Northern Alpine Foreland. The northern part of this sandy plateau includes a highly fertile flint area which is no longer affected by the folding processes found in the Alps, while the southern part is covered with morainic hills. Between these are fields of fluvio-glacial out-wash, such as around Munich. Wherever these deposits get thinner, the ground water can permeate the gravel surface and flood the area, leading to marshes as in the north of Munich.



Aerial view of Munich city centre (facing southeast)

Climate

According to the Köppen climate classification, the climate is oceanic (*Cfb*) bordering on humid continental (*Dfb*), with features like warm to hot summers and cold winters, but without permanent snow cover.^[90]^[91] The city centre lies between both climates, while the airport of Munich has a humid continental climate. The warmest month, on average, is July. The coolest is January.



View of Munich with the Alps in the background

The proximity to the Alps brings higher volumes of rainfall and consequently greater susceptibility to flood problems. Studies of adaptation to climate change and extreme events are carried out; one of them is the Isar Plan of the EU Adaptation Climate.^[92]

Showers and thunderstorms bring the highest average monthly precipitation in late spring and throughout the summer. The most precipitation occurs in July, on average. Winter tends to have less precipitation, the least in February.

The higher elevation and proximity to the Alps cause the city to have more rain and snow than many other parts of Germany. The Alps affect the city's climate in other ways too; for example, the warm downhill wind from the Alps (föhn wind), which can raise temperatures sharply within a few hours even in the winter.

Being at the centre of Europe, Munich is subject to many climatic influences, so that weather conditions there are more variable than in other European cities, especially those further west and south of the Alps.

Munich is near the Alps. Annual variation in temperature can be significant, because there are no large bodies of water nearby. The winter in Munich is generally cold and overcast, and some Munich winters have significant snow. January is the coldest month. While winter averages remain only moderately cold, and relatively mild for an elevated inland location of Munich's latitude, inversion from the nearby Alps causes cold air to sink and result in temperatures below −15 °C (5 °F). In Munich the summer is usually pleasantly warm, with daytime temperatures averaging 25 °C (77 °F).

Munich is subject to active convective seasons and sometimes damaging events. The Alpine thunderstorm system moves along the mountain range, or detaches, heading east-north-east over the foothills of the Alps.^[93]

At Munich's official weather stations, the highest and lowest temperatures ever measured are 37.5 °C (100 °F), on 27 July 1983 in Trudering-Riem, and −31.6 °C (−24.9 °F), on 12 February 1929 in the Botanic Garden of the city.^[94]^[95]

Climate data for Munich (Dreimühlenviertel) (1991–2020 normals, extremes 1954–present)													
Month	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Year
Record high °C (°F)	18.9 (66.0)	21.4 (70.5)	24.0 (75.2)	32.2 (90.0)	31.8 (89.2)	35.2 (95.4)	37.5 (99.5)	37.0 (98.6)	31.8 (89.2)	28.2 (82.8)	24.2 (75.6)	21.7 (71.1)	37.5 (99.5)
Mean maximum °C (°F)	11.8 (53.2)	13.7 (56.7)	18.9 (66.0)	23.6 (74.5)	27.5 (81.5)	30.5 (86.9)	31.9 (89.4)	31.5 (88.7)	26.8 (80.2)	22.6 (72.7)	17.0 (62.6)	12.6 (54.7)	33.1 (91.6)
Mean daily maximum °C (°F)	4.0 (39.2)	5.6 (42.1)	10.1 (50.2)	15.2 (59.4)	19.4 (66.9)	22.9 (73.2)	24.9 (76.8)	24.7 (76.5)	19.6 (67.3)	14.5 (58.1)	8.2 (46.8)	4.8 (40.6)	14.5 (58.1)
Daily mean °C (°F)	0.9 (33.6)	1.9 (35.4)	5.7 (42.3)	10.2 (50.4)	14.3 (57.7)	17.8 (64.0)	19.6 (67.3)	19.4 (66.9)	14.7 (58.5)	10.1 (50.2)	4.9 (40.8)	1.8 (35.2)	10.1 (50.2)
Mean daily minimum °C (°F)	−1.8 (28.8)	−1.4 (29.5)	1.7 (35.1)	5.3 (41.5)	9.3 (48.7)	12.9 (55.2)	14.7 (58.5)	14.5 (58.1)	10.4 (50.7)	6.5 (43.7)	2.1 (35.8)	−0.8 (30.6)	6.1 (43.0)
Mean minimum °C (°F)	−13.8 (7.2)	−12.4 (9.7)	−7.3 (18.9)	−3.3 (26.1)	1.5 (34.7)	5.3 (41.5)	7.8 (46.0)	6.6 (43.9)	1.9 (35.4)	−2.1 (28.2)	−6.8 (19.8)	−12.3 (9.9)	−16.8 (1.8)
Record low °C (°F)	−22.2 (−8.0)	−25.4 (−13.7)	−16.0 (3.2)	−6.0 (21.2)	−2.3 (27.9)	1.0 (33.8)	6.5 (43.7)	4.8 (40.6)	0.6 (33.1)	−4.5 (23.9)	−11.0 (12.2)	−20.7 (−5.3)	−25.4 (−13.7)
Average precipitation mm (inches)	51.9 (2.04)	45.5 (1.79)	61.2 (2.41)	56.0 (2.20)	107.0 (4.21)	120.9 (4.76)	118.9 (4.68)	116.5 (4.59)	78.1 (3.07)	66.9 (2.63)	58.4 (2.30)	58.5 (2.30)	939.7 (37.00)
Average precipitation days (≥ 1.0 mm)	15.3	14.0	15.6	13.5	16.1	16.7	16.1	15.0	14.2	14.2	14.6	16.8	182.0
Average snowy days (≥ 1.0 cm)	11.7	11.2	4.5	0.6	0	0	0	0	0	0	3.3	8.0	39.3
Average relative humidity (%)	80.3	75.9	70.7	64.6	67.2	67.2	66.1	68.1	75.5	79.9	83.3	82.3	73.4
Mean monthly sunshine hours	74.6	95.2	145.3	186.0	213.0	223.7	241.4	232.1	169.7	123.3	74.0	66.4	1,841.4
Source 1: World Meteorological Organization ^[96]													
Source 2: DWD ^[97] SKlima.de ^[98] Infoclimat ^[99]													

Climate change

In Munich, the general trend of global warming with a rise of medium yearly temperatures of about 1 °C (1.8 °F) in Germany between 1900 and 2020 can be observed as well. In November 2016 the city council concluded officially that a further rise in medium temperature, a higher number of heat extremes, a rise in the number of hot days and nights with temperatures higher than 20 °C (tropical nights), a change in precipitation patterns, as well as a rise in the number of local instances of heavy rain, is to be expected as part of the ongoing climate change. The city administration decided to support a joint study from its own Referat für Gesundheit und Umwelt (department for health and environmental issues) and the German Meteorological Service that will gather data on local weather. The data is supposed to be used to create a plan for action for adapting the

city to better deal with climate change as well as an integrated action program for climate protection in Munich. With the help of those programs issues regarding spatial planning and settlement density, the development of buildings and green spaces as well as plans for functioning ventilation in a cityscape can be monitored and managed.^[100]

Demographics

From only 24,000 inhabitants in 1700, the city population doubled about every 30 years. It was 100,000 in 1852, 250,000 in 1883 and 500,000 in 1901. Since then, Munich has become Germany's third-largest city. In 1933, 840,901 inhabitants were counted, and in 1957 over 1 million. Munich has reached 1.5 million in 2022.

Immigration

In December 2023, Munich had 1.58 million inhabitants; 477,855 foreign nationals resided in the city as of 31 December 2023 with 42.88% of these residents being citizens of EU member states, and 29.66% citizens in European states not in the EU (including Kosovo and Turkey).^[101] Along with the Turks, the Croats are one of the two largest foreign minorities in the city, which is why some Croats refer to Munich as their "second capital".^[102] The largest groups of foreign nationals were Turks (38,947), Croats (37,541), Italians (28,142), Greeks (24,843), Bosnians (24,161), Ukrainians (21,899), and Austrians (21,944).

Religion

About 45% of Munich's residents are not affiliated with any religious group; this ratio represents the fastest growing segment of the population. As in the rest of Germany, the Catholic and Protestant churches have experienced a continuous decline in membership. As of 31 December 2017, 31.8% of the city's inhabitants were Catholic, 11.4% Protestant, 0.3% Jewish (see: History of the Jews in Munich),^[103] and 3.6% were members of an Orthodox Church (Eastern Orthodox or Oriental Orthodox).^[104] About 1% adhere to other Christian denominations. There is also a small Old Catholic parish and an English-speaking parish of the Episcopal Church in the city. According to Munich Statistical Office, in 2013 about 6.9% of Munich's population was Muslim.^[105] Munich has the largest Uyghur population with about 800 (whole Germany about 1,600) people with Uyghur diaspora. Many of them fled to Munich due to the Chinese government and are exiled in Munich. Munich is also home to World Uyghur Congress, which is an international organisation of exiled Uyghurs.^[106]

Government and politics

As the capital of Bavaria, Munich is an important political centre for both the state and country as a whole. It is the seat of the Landtag of Bavaria, the State Chancellery, and all state departments. Several national and international authorities are located in Munich, including the Federal Finance Court of Germany, the German Patent Office and the European Patent Office. Bavaria has been dominated by the Christian Social Union in Bavaria (CSU) on a federal, state, and local level since the establishment of the Federal Republic in 1949.

Historical population		
Year	Pop.	±%
1500	13,447	—
1600	21,943	+63.2%
1750	32,000	+45.8%
1880	230,023	+618.8%
1890	349,024	+51.7%
1900	499,932	+43.2%
1910	596,467	+19.3%
1920	666,000	+11.7%
1930	728,900	+9.4%
1940	834,500	+14.5%
1950	823,892	−1.3%
1960	1,055,457	+28.1%
1970	1,311,978	+24.3%
1980	1,298,941	−1.0%
1990	1,229,026	−5.4%
2001	1,227,958	−0.1%
2011	1,348,335	+9.8%
2022	1,478,638	+9.7%

Population size may be affected by changes in administrative divisions.

Mayor

The current mayor of Munich is Dieter Reiter, he is from the Social Democratic Party of Germany (SPD). He was elected in 2014 and re-elected in 2020. He will be succeeded by Dominik Krause of the Greens on 1 May 2026.

The most recent mayoral election was held on 8 March 2026, with a runoff held on 22 March, and the results were as follows:

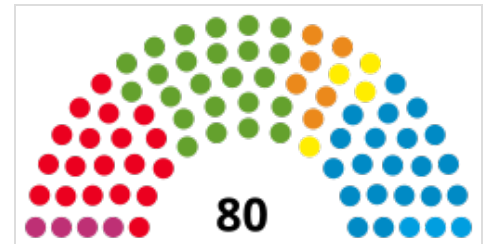


The Bavarian State Chancellery serves as the executive office of the Minister-President of Bavaria.

Candidate		Party	First round		Second round	
			Votes	%	Votes	%
	<u>Dominik Krause</u>	<u>The Greens</u>	168,166	29.5	272,533	56.4
	<u>Dieter Reiter</u>	<u>Social Democratic Party</u>	203,205	35.6	211,075	43.6
	<u>Clemens Baumgärtner</u>	<u>Christian Social Union</u>	121,760	21.3		
	<u>Markus Walbrunn</u>	<u>Alternative for Germany</u>	25,054	4.4		
	<u>Stefan Jagel</u>	<u>The Left</u>	13,781	2.4		
	<u>Michael Piazolo</u>	<u>Free Voters of Bavaria</u>	10,632	1.9		
	<u>Tobias Ruff</u>	<u>Ecological Democratic Party</u>	7,886	1.4		
	<u>Jörg Hoffmann</u>	<u>Free Democratic Party</u>	6,990	1.2		
	<u>Felix Sproll</u>	<u>Volt</u>	6,123	1.1		
	<u>Christiane Pfau</u>	<u>Bündnis Kultur</u>	2,004	0.4		
	<u>Philipp Drabinski</u>	<u>Die PARTEI</u>	1,981	0.3		
	<u>Dirk Höpner</u>	<u>Munich List</u>	1,704	0.3		
	<u>Richard Progl</u>	<u>Bavaria Party</u>	1,285	0.2		
Valid votes			570,571	99.6	483.608	99.5
Invalid votes			2,482	0.4	2,615	0.5
Total			573,053	100.0	486,223	100.0
Electorate/voter turnout			1,094,823	52.3	1,092,561	44.5
Source: <u>Wahlen München</u> (https://www.wahlen-muenchen.de) (1st round, 2nd round)						

City council

The Munich city council (*Stadttrat*) governs the city alongside the Mayor. The most recent city council election was held on 15 March 2020, and the results were as follows:



Groups in the council:

- ☐ Left/PARTEI: 4 seats
- ☐ SPD/Volt: 19 seats
- ☐ Greens/Pink List: 24 seats
- ☐ ÖDP/FW: 6 seats
- ☐ FDP/BP: 4 seats
- ☐ CSU: 20 seats
- ☐ AfD: 3 seats

Party	Lead candidate	Votes	%	+/-	Seats	+/-
<u>Alliance 90/The Greens</u> (Grüne)	Katrin Habenschaden	11,762,516	29.1	▲ 12.5	23	▲ 10
<u>Christian Social Union</u> (CSU)	Kristina Frank	9,986,014	24.7	▼ 7.8	20	▼ 6
<u>Social Democratic Party</u> (SPD)	<u>Dieter Reiter</u>	8,884,562	22.0	▼ 8.8	18	▼ 7
<u>Ecological Democratic Party</u> (ÖDP)	Tobias Ruff	1,598,539	4.0	▲ 1.4	3	▲ 1
<u>Alternative for Germany</u> (AfD)	Iris Wassill	1,559,476	3.9	▲ 1.4	3	▲ 1
<u>Free Democratic Party</u> (FDP)	Jörg Hoffmann	1,420,194	3.5	▲ 0.1	3	±0
<u>The Left</u> (Die Linke)	Stefan Jagel	1,319,464	3.3	▲ 0.8	3	▲ 1
<u>Free Voters of Bavaria</u> (FW)	Hans-Peter Mehling	1,008,400	2.5	▼ 0.2	2	±0
<u>Volt Germany</u> (Volt)	Felix Sproll	732,853	1.8	New	1	New
<u>Die PARTEI</u> (PARTEI)	Marie Burneleit	528,949	1.3	New	1	New
<u>Pink List</u> (Rosa Liste) ^[b]	Thomas Niederbühl	396,324	1.0	▼ 0.9	1	±0
<u>Munich List</u>	Dirk Höpner	339,705	0.8	New	1	New
<u>Bavaria Party</u> (BP)	Richard Progl	273,737	0.7	▼ 0.2	1	±0
mut	Stephanie Dilba	247,679	0.6	New	0	New
FAIR	Kemal Orak	142,455	0.4	New	0	New
<u>Together Bavaria</u> (ZuBa)	Cetin Oraner	120,975	0.3	New	0	New
BIA	Karl Richter	86,358	0.2	▼ 0.5	0	±0
Valid votes		531,527	97.6			
Invalid votes		12,937	2.4			
Total		544,464	100.0		80	±0
Electorate/voter turnout		1,110,571	49.0	▲ 7.0		
Source: Wahlen München ^[107]						

The governing coalition after the 2020 election consisted of the Greens and the SPD, as well as the allied Volt and Pink List, which had one seat each. While the Greens had gained the most seats in the city council, the mayor was from the SPD. The parties made an agreement including social and ecological goals and focusing on heightening stipulations for new development in the city. The Red-Green alliance is a reprise of the 1990–2014 coalition, which was interrupted by a six-year CSU-SPD majority from 2014 to 2020.^{[108][109]}

State Landtag

In the Landtag of Bavaria, Munich is divided between nine constituencies. After the 2018 Bavarian state election, the composition and representation of each was as follows:

Constituency	Area	Party	Member
101 München-Hadern	- Sendling-Westpark, Hadern - Parts of Thalkirchen-Obersendling-Forstenried-Fürstenried-Solln and Laim	<u>CSU</u>	<u>Georg Eisenreich</u>
102 München-Bogenhausen	- Bogenhausen, Berg am Laim - Parts of Au-Haidhausen	<u>CSU</u>	Robert Brannekämper
103 München-Giesing	- Sendling, Obergiesing-Fasangarten - Parts of Untergiesing-Harlaching and Thalkirchen-Obersendling-Forstenried-Fürstenried-Solln	<u>GRÜNE</u>	Gülseren Demirel
104 München-Milbertshofen	- Milbertshofen-Am Hart, Schwabing-West - Parts of Neuhausen-Nymphenburg	<u>GRÜNE</u>	<u>Katharina Schulze</u>
105 München-Moosach	- Moosach, Feldmoching-Hasenbergl - Parts of Neuhausen-Nymphenburg	<u>GRÜNE</u>	<u>Benjamin Adjei</u>
106 München-Pasing	- Pasing-Obermenzing, Aubing-Lochhausen-Langwied, Allach-Untermenzing - Parts of Laim	<u>CSU</u>	Josef Schmid
107 München-Ramersdorf	Ramersdorf-Perlach, Trudering-Riem	<u>CSU</u>	<u>Markus Blume</u>
108 München-Schwabing	Schwabing-Freimann, Maxvorstadt, Altstadt-Lehe	<u>GRÜNE</u>	Christian Hierneis
109 München-Mitte	- Ludwigsvorstadt-Isarvorstadt, Schwanthalerhöhe - Parts of Au-Haidhausen and Untergiesing-Harlaching	<u>GRÜNE</u>	<u>Ludwig Hartmann</u>



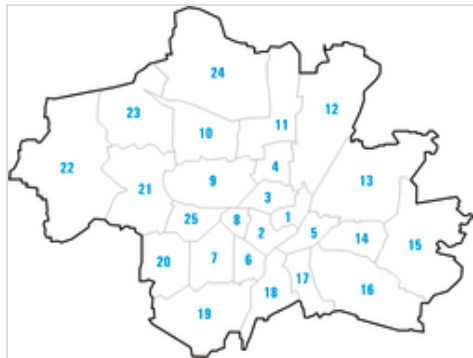
The Maximilianeum is the seat of the Bavarian State Parliament.

Federal parliament

In the Bundestag, Munich is divided between four constituencies. In the 20th Bundestag, the composition and representation of each was as follows:

Constituency	Area	Party	Member
<u>217 Munich North</u>	▪ Maxvorstadt, Schwabing-West, Moosach, Milbertshofen-Am Hart, Schwabing-Freimann, Feldmoching-Hasenbergl	<u>CSU</u>	<u>Bernhard Loos</u>
<u>218 Munich East</u>	▪ Altstadt-Lehel, Au-Haidhausen, Bogenhausen, Berg am Laim, Trudering-Riem, Ramersdorf-Perlach	<u>CSU</u>	<u>Wolfgang Stefinger</u>
<u>219 Munich South</u>	▪ Sendling, Sendling-Westpark, Obergiesing, Untergiesing-Harlaching, Thalkirchen-Obersendling-Forstenried-Fürstenried-Solln, Hadern	<u>GRÜNE</u>	<u>Jamila Schäfer</u>
<u>220 Munich West/Centre</u>	▪ Ludwigsvorstadt-Isarvorstadt, Schwanthalerhöhe, Neuhausen-Nymphenburg, Pasing-Obermenzing, Aubing-Lochhausen-Langwied, Allach-Untermenzing, Laim	<u>CSU</u>	<u>Stephan Pilsinger</u>

Subdivisions



Munich's boroughs

Since the reform of 1992, Munich is divided into 25 administrative boroughs (*Stadtbezirke*). They are subdivided into 105 statistical areas.

Allach-Untermenzing (23), Altstadt-Lehel (1), Aubing-Lochhausen-Langwied (22), Au-Haidhausen (5), Berg am Laim (14), Bogenhausen (13), Feldmoching-Hasenbergl (24), Hadern (20), Laim (25), Ludwigsvorstadt-Isarvorstadt (2), Maxvorstadt (3), Milbertshofen-Am Hart (11), Moosach (10), Neuhausen-Nymphenburg (9), Obergiesing (17), Pasing-Obermenzing (21), Ramersdorf-Perlach (16), Schwabing-Freimann (12), Schwabing-West (4), Schwanthalerhöhe (8), Sendling (6), Sendling-Westpark (7), Thalkirchen-Obersendling-Forstenried-Fürstenried-Solln (19), Trudering-Riem (15), and Untergiesing-

Harlaching (18).

There is no official division into districts. The number of districts is about 50, and if smaller units are counted as well, there are about 90 to 100 (see map). The three largest districts are Schwabing in the north (about 110,000 inhabitants), Sendling in the southwest (about 100,000 inhabitants), and Giesing in the south (about 80,000 inhabitants).^[110]

Architecture

Old Town

At the centre of the old town is the Marienplatz with the Old Town Hall and the New Town Hall. Its tower contains the Rathaus-Glockenspiel. The Peterskirche is the oldest church of the inner city. Nearby St. Peter, the Gothic hall-church Heiliggeistkirche was converted to baroque style from 1724 onwards and looks down

upon the Viktualienmarkt. Three gates of the demolished medieval fortification survive; these are the Isartor, the Sendlinger Tor, and the Karlstor. The Karlstor leads up to the Stachus, a square dominated by the Justizpalast (Palace of Justice).

The Frauenkirche serves as the cathedral for the Catholic Archdiocese of Munich and Freising. The nearby Michaelskirche is the largest renaissance church north of the Alps, while the Theatinerkirche is a basilica in Italianate high baroque, which had a major influence on southern German baroque architecture. Its dome dominates the Odeonsplatz.



The Frauenkirche, consecrated in 1494, is a landmark and symbol of Munich.

Palaces and castles

Schloss Nymphenburg (Nymphenburg Palace, construction started 1664) is a museum open to the public for tours.^{[111][112]}

The smaller Schloss Fürstenried (Fürstenried Palace, construction 1715–1717) is used by the Archdiocese of Munich and Freising as a conference location.^[113]

Schloss Blumenburg (Blutenburg Castle) opened as a children's library in 2024,^[114] but visitors may tour the late-Gothic Blutenburg Castle Church built on the same grounds.^[115]



Old Town Hall and Heiliggeistkirche seen from Viktualienmarkt

The large Munich Residenz complex on the edge of Munich's Old Town now ranks among Europe's most significant museums of interior decoration. Within the Residenz is the splendid Cuvilliés Theatre and next door is the National Theatre Munich. Among the mansions that still exist in Munich are the Palais Porcia, the Palais Preysing, the Palais Holnstein and the Prinz-Carl-Palais. All mansions are situated close to the Residenz, so is the Alter Hof, the first residence of the House of Wittelsbach.

Modernist architecture

Despite Munich being the breeding ground for German Jugendstil, starting with the architect Martin Dülfer, Munich Jugendstil style was quickly submerged as historic trash. While the modernist architect Theodor Fischer was based in Munich, his influence on Munich underwhelmed. Prior to 1914 the city of Munich was under-industrialized. During the Weimar Republic, the Munich establishment was hostile to modernism. The TUM professor German Bestelmeyer favored a conservative style, and Jacobus Oud was rejected for the post of city building chief. Modernist exceptions include a series of post offices by Robert Vorhoelzer built in the late 1920s and early 1930s. Examples of avant-garde temporary constructions include the *Wohnmaschine* (*Housing Machine*) by Robert Vorhoelzer, as well as the *Flachdachhaus* (*Flat Roof House*) by Fritz Norkauer. Paul Schultze-Naumburg, and the Kampfbund enjoyed particular popularity.^[116]

High rise buildings

Several high-rise buildings are clustered at the northern edge of Munich in the skyline, like the HVB Tower, the Arabella High-Rise Building, the Highlight Towers, Uptown Munich, Münchner Tor and the BMW Headquarters next to the Olympic Park. Further high-rise buildings are located in the Werksviertel in Berg am Laim.

Long-term residential development

Munich is subject to a long-term residential development plan that is established by the city administration of Munich. The LaSie ("Langfristige Siedlungsentwicklung") was passed in 2011 in response to the acute housing crisis. LaSie is aligned with the strategic development plan passed for Munich in 1998 ("Perspektive München"). LaSie defines three priorities for the construction of residential housing in Munich. Existing housing estates, post-war low-density developments, and the suburban area are subject to densification ("Nachverdichtung"). Non-residential industrial areas are subject to conservation and will be turned into residential and mixed-use areas. On greenfield sites in the Munich periphery medium and large-scale housing estates are to be built so as to extend Munich's urban center.^[117]

Parks

Friedrich Ludwig von Sckell became famous for designing the Englischer Garten between 1789 and 1807. Besides planning the first public garden in Europe, Sckell also redesigned Baroque gardens as landscape gardens, including the parks of Nymphenburg Palace and the Botanischer Garten München-Nymphenburg.^[118]



Englischer Garten with Munich skyline

Other large green spaces are the Olympiapark, the Westpark and the Ostpark. The city's oldest park is the Hofgarten, near the Residenz, dating back to the 16th century. The site of the largest beer garden in town, the former royal Hirschgarten, was founded in 1780.^[119]

Culture

Language

German is spoken and understood in and around Munich. While the German language has many dialects, so-called "Standard German" or "High German" is learned in schools and spoken among Germans, Austrians and in some parts of Switzerland. A speaker of a Low German dialect in Hamburg may find it difficult to understand the dialect of a Bavarian mountaineer.^[120] The Bavarian dialects are recognized as regional languages and continue to be spoken alongside Standard German.^[121]

Museums

The gothic Morris dancers of Erasmus Grasser are exhibited in the Munich City Museum in the old gothic arsenal building in the inner city.



The Deutsches Museum is the world's largest museum of science and technology.

In 1903 Oskar von Miller assembled a group of engineers and industrialists, who chartered the Deutsches Museum. The Museum was built with the financial support of the German business and imperial nobility community, as well as the blessing of Wilhelm II, German Emperor.^[122] The Deutsches Museum had its grand opening in 1925; it is the world's largest museum of science and technology.^[123] The Deutsches Museum now operates three locations. The original site in central Munich continues to expand its exhibits.^[124]



Bavarian National Museum

The city has several important art galleries, most of which can be found in the Kunstareal. The Lenbachhaus displays works of the movement Der Blaue Reiter (The Blue Rider), a Munich-based modernist art.^[125] Starting in the 1970s, German municipalities started to respond to cultural tourism and invested in public museums. The Neue Pinakothek, like other German museums, was wholly reconstructed from 1974 until 1981.^[126] The Pinakothek der Moderne exhibits an eclectic mix of contemporary art. The principal focus of its permanent collection is Classical Moderns, but the displays are enhanced continuously with gifts from private collections.^[127]

City guides published in the early 1860s directed tourists to Munich's architecture and art collections, which at the time were unique in Germany and are a legacy mainly of Ludwig I of Bavaria, with contributions from Maximilian II of Bavaria.^[128] The Alte Pinakothek contains works of European masters between the 14th and 18th centuries. Major displays include Albrecht Dürer's Self-Portrait (1500), his Four Apostles, Raphael's paintings The Canigiani Holy Family and Madonna Tempi as well as Peter Paul Rubens large

Judgment Day.

An extensive collection of Greek and Roman art is held in the Glyptothek^[129] and the Staatliche Antikensammlungen (the State Antiquities Collections). Works on display include the Medusa Rondanini, the Barberini Faun and figures from the Temple of Aphaea on Aegina for the Glyptothek.^[130] Another museum is the Staatliche Sammlung für Ägyptische Kunst (the State Collection of Egyptian Art).^{[131][132][133]}



The Glyptothek houses King Ludwig I's collection of Greek and Roman sculptures.

Several public collections of LMU Munich are still housed in the Kunstareal. The expanded state collections are housed in the Paläontologisches Museum München, and the Zoologische Staatssammlung München. After the first German art exhibition in the Glaspalast for an international audience in 1869, Munich emerged as a focal point for the arts. Men of distinction from around the world visited the Academy of Fine Arts under the directorship of Karl von Piloty and later Wilhelm von Kaulbach.^[134]

The Museum Five Continents is the second largest collection in Germany of artefacts and objects from outside Europe, while the Bavarian National Museum and the adjoining Bavarian State Archaeological Collection display regional art and cultural history. The Schackgalerie is an important gallery of German 19th-century paintings.^[135]

The memorial museum of the former Dachau concentration camp is just outside the city.

Music

Munich is a major international musical centre and has played host to many prominent composers including Orlande de Lassus, Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart, Carl Maria von Weber, Richard Wagner, Gustav Mahler, Richard Strauss, Max Reger and Carl Orff. Some of classical music's best-known compositions have been created in and around Munich by composers born in the area, for example, Richard Strauss's tone poem Also sprach Zarathustra or Carl Orff's Carmina Burana.^[136]

Opera

Richard Wagner was a supporter of William I, German Emperor, but Wagner only found a generous patron in Ludwig II of Bavaria.^[137] 1870 til 1871 Wagner premiered *Die Meistersinger von Nürnberg* (*The Mastersingers of Nuremberg*) in Munich, a popular success for Wagner and King Ludwig II. Wagner premiered at the Hoftheater, now the National Theatre Munich, with Angelo Quaglio the Younger designing the premiere production.^[138]

The National Theatre Munich is now home to the Bavarian State Opera and the Bavarian State Orchestra. Next door, the modern Residenz Theatre was erected in the building that also houses the Cuvilliés Theatre. The Staatstheater am Gärtnerplatz is a state theater while another opera house, the Prinzregententheater, has become the home of the Bavarian Theater Academy and the Munich Chamber Orchestra.



The National Theatre is home to the Bavarian State Opera and the Bavarian State Orchestra.

Orchestra

The modern Gasteig centre houses the Munich Philharmonic Orchestra. The third orchestra in Munich with international importance is the Bavarian Radio Symphony Orchestra. Its primary concert venue is the Herkulesaal in the former city royal residence, the Munich Residenz. Many important conductors have been attracted by the city's orchestras, including Felix Weingartner, Hans Pfitzner, Hans Rosbaud, Hans Knappertsbusch, Sergiu Celibidache, James Levine, Christian Thielemann, Lorin Maazel, Rafael Kubelík, Eugen Jochum, Sir Colin Davis, Mariss Jansons, Bruno Walter, Georg Solti, Zubin Mehta and Kent Nagano. A stage for shows, big events and musicals is the Deutsche Theater. It is Germany's largest theatre for guest performances.^[139]



Staatstheater am Gärtnerplatz

Pop and electronica

Munich was the centre of Krautrock in southern Germany, with many important bands such as Amon Düül II, Embryo or Popol Vuh hailing from the city. In the 1970s, the Musicland Studios developed into one of the most prominent recording studios in the world, with bands such as the Rolling Stones, Led Zeppelin, Deep Purple and Queen recording albums there. Munich also played a significant role in the development of electronic music, with genre pioneer Giorgio Moroder, who invented synth disco and electronic dance music, and Donna Summer, one of disco music's most important performers, both living and working in the city. In the late 1990s, Electroclash was substantially co-invented if not even invented in Munich, when DJ Hell introduced and assembled international pioneers of this musical genre through his International DeeJay Gigolo Records label here.^[140]

Other notable musicians and bands from Munich include Konstantin Wecker, Willy Astor, Spider Murphy Gang, Münchener Freiheit, Lou Bega, Megaherz, FSK, Colour Haze and Sportfreunde Stiller.

Munich hosted several *Love Parades* and *Mayday Party* rave events throughout the 1990s. Munich continues to rave, the local youth scenes are active.^[141]

Theatre

The Munich Kammerspiele is one of the most important German-language theaters. Since Gotthold Ephraim Lessing's premieres in 1775 many important writers have staged their plays in Munich, they include Christian Friedrich Hebbel, Henrik Ibsen, and Hugo von Hofmannsthal.

Schwabing

At the turn of the 20th century Schwabing was a preeminent cultural metropolis. Schwabing was an epicenter for both literature and the fine arts, with numerous German and non-German artists living there.^[142]

Vladimir Lenin authored *What Is to Be Done?* while living in Schwabing. Central to Schwabing's bohemian scene were *Künstlerlokale* (*Artist's Cafés*) like Café Stefanie or Kabarett Simpl, whose liberal ways differed fundamentally from Munich's more traditional localities. The Simpl, which survives to this day, was named after Munich's anti-authoritarian satirical magazine *Simplicissimus*, founded in 1896 by Albert Langen and Thomas Theodor Heine, which quickly became an important organ of the *Schwabinger Bohème*. Its caricatures and biting satirical attacks on Wilhelmine German society were the result of countless of collaborative efforts by many of the best visual artists and writers from Munich and elsewhere.



Wassily Kandinsky's *Houses in Munich* (1908)

In 1971 Eckart Witzigmann teamed up with a Munich building contractor to finance and open the *Tantris* restaurant in Schwabing. Witzigmann is credited for starting the German *Küchenwunder* (*kitchen wonder*).^[143]

Biedermeier

The Biedermeier era was named after a character that regularly appeared in the satire magazine *Münchener Fliegende Blätter* (*Loose Munich Pages*), which was published by Adolf Kussmaul and Ludwig Eichrodt in Munich between 1855 and 1857. Biedermeier was a synonym for arts, furniture, and the lifestyle of the nonheroic middle class. The Biedermeier era painters Ferdinand Georg Waldmüller, Moritz von Schwind, and Carl Spitzweg are shown in the Neue Pinakothek.^[144]

Prinzregentenzeit

Celebrity literary figures worked in Munich especially during the final decades of the Kingdom of Bavaria, the so-called *Prinzregentenzeit* (literally *prince regent's time*) under the reign of Luitpold, Prince Regent of Bavaria. This includes Thomas Mann, Heinrich Mann, Paul Johann Ludwig von Heyse, Rainer Maria Rilke, Ludwig Thoma, Fanny zu Reventlow, Oskar Panizza, Gustav Meyrink, Max Halbe, Erich Mühsam and Frank Wedekind.

Weimar Republic

The period immediately before World War I saw continued economic and cultural prominence for the city. Thomas Mann wrote in his novella *Gladius Dei* about this period: "München leuchtete" (literally "Munich shone"). Munich remained a centre of cultural life during the Weimar Republic, with figures such as Lion Feuchtwanger, Bertolt Brecht, Peter Paul Althaus, Stefan George, Ricarda Huch, Joachim Ringelnatz, Oskar Maria Graf, Annette Kolb, Ernst Toller, Hugo Ball, and Klaus Mann adding to the already established big names.^[145]

Karl Valentin, the cabaret performer and comedian, is to this day remembered and beloved as a cultural icon of his hometown. Between 1910 and 1940, he wrote and performed in many absurdist sketches and short films that were highly influential, earning him the nickname of "Charlie Chaplin of Germany".^{[146][147]}

Liesl Karlstadt, before working together with Valentin, cross-dressed and performed cabaret with yodeling on stage and in Munich's Cafe-Theatres. The cabaret scene was crushed when the Nazis seized power in 1933 and Karlstadt was saved from Nazi sterilization by a doctor. Contemporary Munich cabaret still reverences 1920s cabaret, the Munich alternative rock band F.S.K. absorbs yodels.^[148]



Post-war literature

After World War II, Munich soon again became a focal point of the German literary scene and remains so to this day, with writers as diverse as Wolfgang Koeppen, Erich Kästner, Eugen Roth, Alfred Andersch, Elfriede Jelinek, Hans Magnus Enzensberger, Michael Ende, Franz Xaver Kroetz, Gerhard Polt and Patrick Süskind calling the city their home.

Fine arts

From the Gothic to the Baroque era, the fine arts were represented in Munich by artists like Erasmus Grasser, Jan Polack, Johann Baptist Straub, Ignaz Günther, Hans Krumpper, Ludwig von Schwanthaler, Cosmas Damian Asam, Egid Quirin Asam, Johann Baptist Zimmermann, Johann Michael Fischer and François de Cuvilliés. Munich had already become an important place for painters like Carl Rottmann, Lovis Corinth, Wilhelm von Kaulbach, Carl Spitzweg, Franz von Lenbach, Franz Stuck, Karl Piloty and Wilhelm Leibl.

Portrait of Oskar Maria Graf by Georg Schrimpf (1927)

Cinema

Munich was (and in some cases, still is) home to many of the most important authors of the New German Cinema movement, including Rainer Werner Fassbinder, Werner Herzog, Edgar Reitz and Herbert Achternbusch. In 1971, the Filmverlag der Autoren was founded, cementing the city's role in the movement's history. Munich served as the location for many of Fassbinder's films, among them Ali: Fear Eats the Soul. The Hotel Deutsche Eiche near Gärtnerplatz was somewhat like a centre of operations for Fassbinder and his "clan" of actors. New German Cinema is considered by far the most important artistic movement in German cinema history since the era of German Expressionism in the 1920s.^{[149][150]}

In 1919, the Bavaria Film Studios were founded, which developed into one of Europe's largest film studios. Directors like Alfred Hitchcock, Billy Wilder, Orson Welles, John Huston, Ingmar Bergman, Stanley Kubrick, Claude Chabrol, Fritz Umgelter, Rainer Werner Fassbinder, Wolfgang Petersen and Wim Wenders made films there. Among the internationally well-known films produced at the studios are The Pleasure Garden (1925) by Alfred Hitchcock, The Great Escape (1963) by John Sturges, Paths of Glory (1957) by Stanley Kubrick, Willy Wonka & the Chocolate Factory (1971) by Mel Stuart and both Das Boot (1981) and The Neverending Story (1984) by Wolfgang Petersen. Munich remains one of the centres of the German film and entertainment industry.^[151]



Logo of Bavaria Film

Festivals

Coopers' Dance

The Coopers' Dance (German: *Schäfflertanz*) is a guild dance of coopers originally started in Munich. Beginning in the early 1800s the custom spread via the travels of journeymen, and it is now a common tradition throughout the Old Bavaria region. The dance was supposed to be held every seven years.^[152]

Strong Beer Festival

Munich is home to the famous Nockherberg Strong Beer Festival (German: *Starkbierfest*) during the Lenten fasting period (usually in March). Its origins go back to the 17th/18th century, but has become popular when the festivities were first televised in the 1980s. The festival includes comical speeches and a mini-musical in which numerous German politicians are parodied by look-alike actors.^[153]

Frühlingsfest

Held for two weeks at the Theresienwiese from the end of April to the beginning of May, celebrating and serving the new local spring beers.^[154]

Auer Dult

A regular event combining a market and a German style folk festival on the Mariahilfplatz. The Auer Dult can be up to 300 stalls, selling handmade crafts, household goods, and local foods.^[155]

Kocherlball

Munich's Kocherlball (*Cooks' Ball*) is an annual event to commemorate all servants, ranging from kitchenhands to cooks. The tradition started in the 19th century.^[156]

Tollwood

Usually held annually in July and December at Olympia Park. The Tollwood Festival showcases fine and performing arts with live music, and several lanes of booths selling handmade crafts, as well as organic food, mostly fusion cuisine.^[157]

Oktoberfest

At Theresienwiese, Munich's Oktoberfest, the largest beer festival and Volksfest in the world, runs for 16–18 days from the end of September through early October. In the last 200 years the festival has grown to span 85 acres and now welcomes over six million visitors every year.

Beer is served from the six major Munich breweries: Augustiner-Bräu, Hacker-Pschorr Brewery, Löwenbräu Brewery, Paulaner Brewery, Spaten-Franziskaner-Bräu, and Staatliches Hofbräuhaus in München. Food must be bought in each tent.^[158]



The Oktoberfest is the world's largest beer festival, attracting around seven million visitors every year.



Schäfflertanz in Neuhausen, 2012



Tollwood Festival

Christkindlmarkt

The Munich Christkindlmarkt started to evolve in the 14th century. The German Christkindlmarkt reached the desired accomplishment in the 17th century in Nuremberg.^[159]

Cuisine and culinary specialties

Munich cuisine is a part of the broader Bavarian cuisine. Munich Weißwurst ("white sausage", *German: Münchner Weißwurst*) was invented in the city in 1857 and is a Munich speciality. Traditionally Weißwurst is served in pubs before noon and is served with sweet mustard and freshly baked pretzels.

Munich has 11 restaurants that have been awarded one or more Michelin Guide stars in 2021.^[160]



Weißwurst with sweet mustard and a pretzel

Beers and breweries



Beer garden in Munich

Munich is known for its breweries and Weissbier (*wheat beer*). Helles, a pale lager with a translucent gold color, is the most popular contemporary Munich beer. Helles has largely replaced Munich's dark beer, known as Dunkel, which gets its color from roasted malt. It was the typical beer in Munich in the 19th century. Starkbier is the strongest Munich beer, with a high alcohol content of 6%–9%. It is dark amber in color and has a heavy malty taste. The beer served at Oktoberfest is a special type of beer with a

higher alcohol content.

Wirtshäuser are traditional Bavarian pubs, many of which also have small outside areas. Biergärten (*beer gardens*) are a popular fixture in Munich's gastronomic landscape. They are central to the city's culture, and are an overt melting pot for members of all walks of life, regardless of social class. There are many smaller beer gardens, but some beer gardens have thousands of seats. Large beer gardens can be found in the Englischer Garten, on the Nockherberg, and in the Hirschgarten.

The six main breweries in Munich are Augustiner-Bräu, Hacker-Pschorr Brewery, Hofbräuhaus, Löwenbräu, Paulaner, and Spaten-Franziskaner-Bräu. Smaller breweries are becoming more prevalent in Munich.

Circus

The Circus Krone based in Munich is one of the largest circuses in Europe.^[161] It was the first and still is one of only a few in Western Europe to also occupy a building of its own.

Nightlife

Nightlife in Munich is located mostly in the boroughs Ludwigsvorstadt-Isarvorstadt, Maxvorstadt, Au-Haidhausen, Berg am Laim and Sendling. Between Sendlinger Tor and Maximiliansplatz, on the edge of the central Altstadt-Lehel district, there is also the so-called Feierbanane (party banana), a roughly banana-shaped unofficial party zone spanning 1.3 km (0.8 mi) along Sonnenstraße, characterized by a high concentration of clubs, bars and restaurants, which became the center of Munich's nightlife in the mid-2000s.^[162]

In the 1960s and 1970s, Schwabing was considered a center of nightlife in Germany, with internationally known clubs such as Big Apple, PN hit-house, Domicile, Hot Club, Piper Club, Tiffany, Germany's first large-scale discotheque Blow Up and the underwater nightclub Yellow Submarine,^{[140][163][164]} and Munich has been called "New York's big disco sister" in this context.^{[140][165]} Bars in the Schwabing district of this era include, among many others, Schwabinger 7 and Schwabinger Podium. Since the 1980s, however, Schwabing has lost much of its nightlife activity due to gentrification and the resulting high rents, and the formerly wild artists' and students' quarter developed into one of the city's most coveted and expensive residential districts, attracting affluent citizens with little interest in partying.^[166]



Bahnwärter Thiel

Beginning in the 1960s, the Rosa Viertel (pink quarter) developed in the Glockenbachviertel and around Gärtnerplatz, which in the 1980s made Munich "one of the four gayest metropolises in the world" along with San Francisco, New York City and Amsterdam.^[167] In particular, the area around Müllerstraße and Hans-Sachs-Straße was characterized by numerous gay bars and nightclubs. One of them was the travesty nightclub Old Mrs. Henderson, where Freddie Mercury, who lived in Munich from 1979 to 1985, filmed the music video for the song "Living on My Own" at his 39th birthday party.^{[167][164][168]}

Since the mid-1990s, the Kunstpark Ost and its successor Kultfabrik, a former industrial complex that was converted to a large party area near München Ostbahnhof in Berg am Laim, hosted more than 30 clubs and was especially popular among younger people from the metropolitan area surrounding Munich and tourists.^{[167][169]} The Kultfabrik was closed at the end of the year 2015 to convert the area into a residential and office area. Apart from the Kultfabrik and the smaller Optimolwerke, there is a wide variety of establishments in the urban parts of nearby Haidhausen. Before the Kunstpark Ost, there had already been an accumulation of internationally known nightclubs in the remains of the abandoned former Munich-Riem Airport.^{[140][170][171]}

Munich nightlife tends to change dramatically and quickly. Establishments open and close every year, and due to gentrification and the overheated housing market many survive only a few years, while others last longer. Beyond the already mentioned venues of the 1960s and 1970s, nightclubs with international recognition in recent history included Tanzlokal Größenwahn, The Atomic Café and the techno clubs Babalu Club, Ultraschall, KW – Das Heizkraftwerk, Natraj Temple, MMA Club (Mixed Munich Arts), Die Registratur and Bob Beaman.^[172] From 1995 to 2001, Munich was also home to the Union Move, one of the largest technoparades in Germany.^[163]



Blitz Club on Museumsinsel

Munich has the highest density of music venues of any German city, followed by Hamburg, Cologne and Berlin.^{[173][174]} Within the city's limits are more than 100 nightclubs and thousands of bars and restaurants.^{[175][176]}

Popular techno nightclubs are Blitz Club, Harry Klein, Rote Sonne, Bahnwärter Thiel, Pimpernel, Charlie, Palais and Pathos.^{[177][178]} Popular mixed music clubs are Call me Drella, Wannda Circus, Tonhalle, Backstage, Muffathalle, Ampere, Pacha, P1, Zenith, Minna Thiel and the party ship Alte Utting.

Sports

Football

Munich is home to several professional Association football teams including the FC Bayern Munich. Other notable clubs include 1860 Munich, who currently play in the 3. Liga. Noticeably, FC Bayern Munich is the most successful club in Germany and it is also very reputed across Europe and the world. Munich hosted matches in the 2006 FIFA World Cup.^[179]



Allianz Arena is the second-largest stadium in Germany and the home stadium of FC Bayern Munich.

Basketball

FC Bayern Munich Basketball is currently playing in the Beko Basket Bundesliga. The city hosted the final stages of the FIBA EuroBasket 1993, where the German national basketball team won the gold medal.

Ice hockey

The city's ice hockey club is EHC Red Bull München who play in the Deutsche Eishockey Liga. The team has won four DEL Championships, in 2016, 2017, 2018 and 2023.

Olympics

Munich hosted the 1972 Summer Olympics; the Munich massacre took place in the Olympic village. It was one of the host cities for the 2006 Football World Cup, which was not held in Munich's Olympic Stadium, but in a new football specific stadium, the Allianz Arena. Munich bid to host the 2018 Winter Olympic Games, but lost to Pyeongchang.^[180]



Olympiasee in the Olympiapark

In October 2025, Munich citizens voted heavily (66%)^[181] in favor of their city's bid to host the 2036, 2040, or 2044 Olympic Games. The pro-bid campaign^[182] focused on ecological and sustainable solutions, social housing, and leveraging existing infrastructure.

Road running

Regular annual road running events in Munich are the Munich Marathon in October, the Stadtlauf end of June, the company run B2Run in July, the New Year's Run on 31 December, the Spartan Race Sprint, the Olympia Alm Crosslauf and the Bestzeitenmarathon.

Swimming

Public sporting facilities in Munich include ten indoor swimming pools^[183] and eight outdoor swimming pools,^[184] which are operated by the Munich City Utilities (SWM) communal company.^[185] Popular indoor swimming pools include the Olympia Schwimmhalle of the 1972 Summer Olympics, the wave pool Cosimawellenbad, as well as the Müllersches Volksbad which was built in 1901. Further, swimming within Munich's city limits is also possible in several artificial lakes such as for example the Riemer See or the Langwieder lake district.^[186]

River surfing

River surfing is a popular sport in Munich. The Flosskanal wave in the south of Munich is less challenging. A well visited surfing spot for experienced surfers is the Eisbach standing wave, where the annual Munich Surf Open is celebrated on the last Saturday of July.^[187]

Economy

Munich has the strongest economy of any German city according to a study^[188] and the lowest unemployment rate (5.4% in July 2020) of any German city of more than a million people (the others being Berlin, Hamburg and Cologne).^{[189][190]} Munich ranks third on the list of German cities by gross domestic product (GDP). In addition, it is one of the most attractive business locations in Germany.^[188] The city is also the economic centre of southern Germany. Munich topped the ranking of the magazine *Capital* in February 2005 for the economic prospects between 2002 and 2011 in 60 German cities.

Munich is a financial, business and commercial center and global city that holds the headquarters of many companies. This includes more companies listed by the DAX than any other German city, as well as the German or European headquarters of many foreign companies such as McDonald's and Microsoft. One of the best-known newly established Munich companies is Flixbus.

Manufacturing

Munich holds the headquarters of Siemens AG (electronics), BMW (car), Traton (truck manufacturer, engineering), MTU Aero Engines (aircraft engine manufacturer), Linde (gases) and Rohde & Schwarz (electronics). Among German cities with more than 500,000 inhabitants, purchasing power is highest in Munich (€26,648 per inhabitant) as of 2007.^[191] In 2006, Munich blue-collar workers enjoyed an average hourly wage of €18.62 (ca. \$20).^[192]

The breakdown by cities proper (not metropolitan areas) of Global 500 cities listed Munich in 8th position in 2009.^[193] Munich is also a centre for biotechnology, software and other service industries. Furthermore, Munich is the home of the headquarters of many other large companies such as the injection moulding machine manufacturer Krauss-Maffei, and its arms manufacturing branch Krauss-Maffei & Wegmann, the camera and lighting manufacturer Arri, the semiconductor firm Infineon Technologies (headquartered in the suburban town of Neubiberg), lighting giant Osram, as well as the German or European headquarters of many foreign companies such as Microsoft.

Finance

Munich has significance as a financial centre (second only to Frankfurt), being home of HypoVereinsbank and the Bayerische Landesbank. It outranks Frankfurt though as home of insurance companies such as Allianz (insurance) and Munich Re (re-insurance).^[194]

Media



BMW Headquarters building (one of the few buildings that has been built from the top to the bottom) and the bowl-shaped BMW Museum



The HypoVereinsbank tower

Munich is the largest publishing city in Europe^[195] and home to the *Süddeutsche Zeitung*, one of Germany's biggest daily newspapers. The city is also the location of the programming headquarters of Germany's largest public broadcasting network, ARD, while the largest commercial network, Pro7-Sat1 Media AG, is headquartered in the suburb of Unterföhring. The headquarters of the German branch of Random House, the world's largest publishing house, and of Burda publishing group are also in Munich.

The Bavaria Film Studios are located in the suburb of Grünwald. They are one of Europe's biggest film production studios.^[196]

Technology

- Teamwire, 2010 technology startup company
- Experteer, 2005 online career and recruitment marketplace

Education

Colleges and universities

Munich is a leading location for science and research with a long list of Nobel Prize laureates from Wilhelm Röntgen in 1901 to Theodor W. Hänsch in 2005.

LMU Munich^[197] and the Technical University of Munich (TUM),^[198] were two of the first three German universities to be awarded the title *elite university* by a selection committee composed of academics and members of the Ministries of Education and Research of the Federation and the German states (Länder).

- LMU Munich), founded in 1472 in Ingolstadt, moved to Munich in 1826
- Technical University of Munich (TUM), founded in 1868
- Akademie der Bildenden Künste München, founded in 1808
- University of the Bundeswehr Munich, founded in 1973 (located in Neubiberg)
- Deutsche Journalistenschule, founded in 1959
- Bayerische Akademie für Außenwirtschaft, founded in 1989
- Hochschule für Musik und Theater München, founded in 1830
- International Max Planck Research School for Molecular and Cellular Life Sciences, founded in 2005
- International School of Management, Germany, founded in 1990
- Katholische Stiftungsfachhochschule München, founded in 1971
- Munich Business School (MBS), founded in 1991
- Munich Intellectual Property Law Center (MIPLC), founded in 2003
- Munich School of Philosophy, founded in 1925 in Pullach, moved to Munich in 1971
- Munich School of Political Science, founded in 1950
- Munich University of Applied Sciences (HM), founded in 1971
- New European College, founded in 2014
- Ukrainian Free University, founded in 1921 (from 1945 – in Munich)
- University of Television and Film Munich (*Hochschule für Fernsehen und Film*), founded in 1966



Main building of LMU Munich



Main building of the Technical University

Primary and secondary schools

Notable Gymnasien in Munich include the Maria-Theresia-Gymnasium, the Luitpold Gymnasium, the Wilhelmsgymnasium, as well as the Wittelsbacher Gymnasium. Munich has several notable international schools, including Lycée Jean Renoir, the Japanische Internationale Schule München, the Bavarian International School, the Munich International School, and the European School, Munich.

Scientific research institutions

Max Planck Society

The Max Planck Society, a government funded non-profit research organization, has its administrative headquarters in Munich.

Fraunhofer Society

The Fraunhofer Society, the German government funded research organization for applied research, has its headquarters in Munich.

Other research institutes

- Botanische Staatssammlung München, a notable herbarium
- Ifo Institute for Economic Research, theoretical and applied research in economics and finance
- Doerner Institute
- European Southern Observatory
- Helmholtz Zentrum München
- Zoologische Staatssammlung München
- German Aerospace Center (DLR), Oberpfaffenhofen bei München

Transport

Munich has an extensive public transport system consisting of an underground metro, trams, buses and high-speed rail. In 2015, the transport modal share in Munich was 38 percent public transport, 25 percent car, 23 percent walking, and 15 percent bicycle.^[199] Its public transport system delivered 566 million passenger trips that year.^[200]

Munich is the hub of a developed regional transportation system, including the second-largest airport in Germany and the Berlin–Munich high-speed railway, which connects Munich to the German capital city with a journey time of about 4 hours. Flixbus which offers intercity coach service is headquartered in Munich.

The trade fair Transport Logistic is held every two years at the *Neue Messe München* (Messe München International).

Public transport

For its urban population of 2.6 million people, Munich and its closest suburbs have a comprehensive network of public transport incorporating the Munich U-Bahn, the Munich S-Bahn, trams and buses. The system is supervised by the Munich Transport and Tariff Association (*Münchner Verkehrs- und Tarifverbund*). The Munich tramway is the oldest existing public transportation system in the city, which has been in operation

since 1876. Munich also has an extensive network of bus lines. The average amount of time people spend commuting to and from work with public transit in Munich on a weekday is 56 min.

The extensive network of subway and tram lines assists and complement pedestrian movement in the city centre. The 700m-long Kaufinger Straße, which starts near the Main train station, forms a pedestrian east–west spine that traverses almost the entire centre. Major spines and many smaller streets cover an extensive area of the centre that can be enjoyed on foot and bike. These attributes result from applying the principle of filtered permeability. Pedestrian and bike paths, which permeate the entire Munich city centre, go through public squares and open spaces for enjoyment. Munich city centre was subject to urban planning and has a comprehensive model for laying out neighborhoods and districts according to grid plan.^[201]



A class R2 *Straßenbahn* (Tram) on route 19 at Ostbahnhof

Cycling

Cycling has a strong presence in the city and is recognized as a good alternative. The growing number of bicycle lanes are widely used throughout the year. Cycle paths can be found alongside the majority of sidewalks and streets, although the newer or renovated ones are much easier to tell apart from pavements than older ones. A modern bike hire system is available within the area bounded by the *Mittlerer Ring*.

Cultural history trails and bicycle routes

Since 2001, historically interesting places in Munich can be explored via the List of cultural history trails in Munich (*KulturGeschichtsPfade*). Sign-posted cycle routes are the Outer *Äußere Radlring* (outer cycle route) and the *RadlRing München*.^[202]



Munich's S-Bahn at the Marienplatz station

Munich Central Train Station

Munich Central Train Station (*München Hauptbahnhof*) is the central railway station located in the city centre and is the long-distance station in Munich.^[203]

Munich Central Train Station serves about 450,000 passengers a day, which puts it on par with other large stations in Germany. Munich Central Train Station alongside München Ost railway station are two of the 21 stations in Germany classified by Deutsche Bahn as a category 1 station.

The central mainline station is a terminal station with 32 platforms. The subterranean S-Bahn with 2 platforms and U-Bahn stations with 6 platforms are through stations.

Intercity-Express (ICE) and EuroCity-Express (ECE; Munich–Bregenz–Zurich) trains – and starting in 2026 also TGV trains (Munich–Paris)^[204] – stop at Munich Central Train Station. InterCity (IC) and EuroCity (EC) trains to destinations east of Munich also stop at the München Ost railway station. Munich is connected to Nuremberg via Ingolstadt by the Nuremberg–Munich high-speed railway and Berlin–Munich high-speed railway.

The old air raid shelter next to platform 11 of Munich Central Train Station was an important distribution point for guest workers (*Gastarbeiter*) between 1960 and 1973. At peak more than 1,000 guest workers arrived per day, in total 1.8 million guest workers passed through Munich Central Train Station.^[205]

Autobahns

Munich is an integral part of the Autobahn network of southern Germany. Motorways from Stuttgart (W), Nuremberg, Frankfurt and Berlin (N), Deggendorf and Passau (E), Salzburg and Innsbruck (SE), Garmisch Partenkirchen (S) and Lindau (SW) terminate at Munich, allowing direct access to the different parts of Germany, Austria and Italy.

Traffic is often very heavy in and around Munich. Traffic congestion are commonplace at the beginning and end of major Bavarian holidays. There are few "green waves" or roundabouts, and an abundance of construction sites.

Munich has introduced an environmental zone and was among the first German cities to require a green sticker for vehicles, these are a requirement when entering the city or driving in the wider surrounding area.^[206]



Munich motorway network

Air

Munich International Airport

Franz Josef Strauss International Airport (IATA: MUC, ICAO: EDDM) is the second-largest airport in Germany and seventh-largest in Europe after London Heathrow, Paris Charles de Gaulle, Frankfurt, Amsterdam, Madrid and Istanbul Atatürk. It is used by about 46 million passengers a year, and lies some 30 km (19 mi) north east of the city centre. It replaced the smaller Munich-Riem Airport in 1992. The airport can be reached by suburban train lines from the city. From the main railway station the journey takes 40–45 minutes. A magnetic levitation train (called Transrapid), which was to have run at speeds of up to 400 km/h (249 mph) from the central station to the airport in a travel time of 10 minutes, had been approved,^[207] but was cancelled in March 2008 because of cost escalation and after heavy protests.^[208] Lufthansa opened its second hub at the airport when Terminal 2 was opened in 2003.



Munich International Airport (MUC)

Other airports

In 2008, the Bavarian state government granted a licence to expand Oberpfaffenhofen Air Station located west of Munich, for commercial use. These plans were opposed by many residents in the Oberpfaffenhofen area as well as other branches of local government, including the city of Munich, which took the case to court.^[209] However, in October 2009, the permit allowing up to 9725 business flights per year to depart from or land at Oberpfaffenhofen was confirmed by a regional judge.^[210]

Despite being 110 km (68 mi) from Munich, Memmingen Airport has been advertised as Airport Munich West. After 2005, passenger traffic of nearby Augsburg Airport was relocated to Munich Airport, leaving the Augsburg region of Bavaria without an air passenger airport within close reach.

International relations

Twin towns and sister cities

Munich is twinned with:^[211]

-  Edinburgh, Scotland, UK (1954)
-  Verona, Italy (1960)
-  Bordeaux, France (1964)
-  Sapporo, Japan (1972)
-  Cincinnati, United States (1989)
-  Kyiv, Ukraine (1989)
-  Harare, Zimbabwe (1996)
-  Beersheba, Israel (2021)

Around Munich

Nearby towns

The Munich agglomeration sprawls across the plain of the Alpine foothills comprising about 2.6 million inhabitants. Several smaller traditional Bavarian towns and cities like Dachau, Freising, Erding, Starnberg, Landshut and Moosburg are today part of the Greater Munich Region, formed by Munich and the surrounding districts, making up the Munich Metropolitan Region, which has a population of about 6 million people.^[4]

Recreation

South of Munich, there are numerous nearby freshwater lakes such as Lake Starnberg, Ammersee, Chiemsee, Walchensee, Kochelsee, Tegernsee, Schliersee, Simssee, Staffelsee, Wörthsee, Kirchsee and the Osterseen (Easter Lakes), which are popular among Munich residents for recreation, swimming and watersports and can be quickly reached by car and a few also by Munich's S-Bahn.^[212]



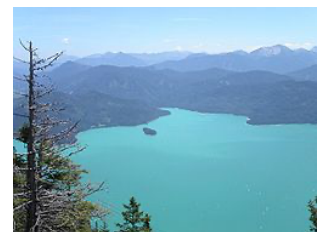
Lake Starnberg



Ammersee



Chiemsee



Walchensee

TegernseeGroßer OsterseeKirchseeSimsseeWörthsee

Notable people

Born in Munich

Entertainment

- Herbert Achternbusch (1938–2022), film director
- Percy Adlon (1935–2024), film director
- Briana Banks, (born 1978), porn actress
- Moritz Bleibtreu (born 1971), actor
- Harry Buckwitz (1904–1987), actor, theatre director and theatre manager
- Gedeon Burkhard (born 1969), actor
- Frida Felser (1872–1941), opera singer and actress.^[213]
- Andy Fetscher (born 1980), film director, cinematographer and screenplay writer
- Maria Furtwängler (born 1966), actress
- Therese Giehse (1898–1975), actress
- Michael Haneke (born 1942), filmmaker and writer
- Michael Herbig (born 1968), comedian, actor and filmmaker
- Werner Herzog (born 1942), film director
- Curd Jürgens (1915–1982), actor
- Rick Kavanian (born 1971), actor and comedian
- Renate Müller (1906–1937), actress
- Max Neal (1865–1941), dramatist

Nobility

- Elisabeth of Bavaria (1837–1898), Empress "Sisi" of Austria
- Isabeau of Bavaria (1371–1435), queen-consort of France
- Prince Leopold of Bavaria (1846–1930), German field marshal
- Ludwig II the Dream King, at Nymphenburg
- Ludwig III of Bavaria (1845–1921), last king of Bavaria
- Maximilian I, Elector of Bavaria (1573–1651), Elector of Bavaria
- Maximilian II of Bavaria (1811–1864), king of Bavaria
- Maximilian II Emanuel, Elector of Bavaria (1662–1726), Elector of Bavaria
- Maximilian III Joseph, Elector of Bavaria (1727–1777), Elector of Bavaria
- Otto of Bavaria (1848–1916), king of Bavaria
- Rupprecht, Crown Prince of Bavaria, (1869–1955), Crown Prince of Bavaria
- Sophie, Hereditary Princess of Liechtenstein (born 1967)

- Christine Neubauer (born 1962), actress
- Uschi Obermaier (born 1946), sex symbol of the late sixties
- Lola Randl (born 1980), film director and screenwriter
- Wolfgang Reitherman (1909–1985), animator and director of Disney movies
- Helmut Ringelmann (1926–2011), film producer and film director
- Jeri Ryan (born 1968), actress
- Till Schmerbeck (born 1969), film producer
- Julia Stegner (born 1984), top model
- Christian Tramitz (born 1955), actor and comedian
- Karl Valentin (1882–1948), comedian, author and film producer
- Fritz Wepper (born 1941), actor
- Nico Liersch (born 2000), actor

Fashion designers

- Willy Bogner (born 1942), fashion designer and director of photography
- Rudolph Moshammer (1940–2005), fashion designer

Musicians

- Lou Bega (born 1975), singer-songwriter
- Harold Faltermeyer (born 1952), composer and record producer
- Julia Fischer (born 1983), classical violinist and pianist
- Max Greger (1926–2015), musician, saxophonist, big band bandleader and conductor
- Joey Heindle (born 1993), DSDS participant in season 9.^[214]
- Jonas Kaufmann (born 1969), operatic tenor
- Franzl Lang (1930–2015), Bavarian yodeller
- Lubomyr Melnyk (born 1948), composer and pianist
- Nick Menza (1964–2016), Megadeth drummer
- Robert Merwald (born 1971), operatic baritone
- Brent Mydland (1952–1990), Grateful Dead keyboardist
- Charles Oberthür (1819–1895), composer
- Carl Orff (1895–1982), composer
- Wolfgang Sawallisch (1923–2013), conductor and pianist
- Ralph Siegel (born 1945), composer
- Richard Strauss (1864–1949), composer

Painters

- Hubert Haider (1879–1971)
- Franz Marc (1880–1916), painter
- Heinrich Spiess (1832–1875), painter
- Karl von Piloty (1826–1886), painter

Photographers

- Yaakov Rosner (1902–1950), photographer

Politicians

- Carl Amery (1922–2005), writer, President of the German PEN Center and founding member of the German Green Party
- Georg Eisenreich (born 1970), politician (CSU)
- Leon Feuchtwanger (1884–1958), writer
- Karl-Theodor zu Guttenberg (born 1971), politician (CSU)
- Heinrich Himmler (1900–1945), leading member of the Nazi Party, main perpetrator of the Holocaust
- Wilhelm Hoegner, (1887–1980), politician
- Carljörg Lacherbauer (1902–1967), co-founder of Christian Social Union (CSU), Post-war mayor and secretary of the Department of Justice
- Heinrich Müller (1900–1945), chief of the Gestapo
- Fritz Schäffer (1888–1967), politician
- Wilhelm Schmid (1889–1934), SA-Gruppenführer and member of the *Reichstag*
- Franz Josef Strauss (1915–1988), Minister-President of the Free State of Bavaria

Professional athletes

- Gary Allison (born 1951), German-born soccer player
- Franz Beckenbauer (1945–2024), former footballer and honorary president of Bayern Munich
- Maxi Herber (1920-2006), figure skater
- Korbinian Holzer (born 1988), professional ice hockey defenceman currently playing for Adler Mannheim of the DEL
- Fabian Johnson (born 1987), German-born soccer player who plays for Borussia Mönchengladbach and the United States National Team
- Philipp Lahm (born 1983), footballer who played for Bayern Munich
- Marcel Nguyen (born 1987), artistic gymnast
- JJ Peterka (born 2002), ice hockey player
- Christoph Schubert (born 1982), former ice hockey player who played in the NHL for the Winnipeg

Journalists and Writers

- Lion Feuchtwanger (1884–1958), writer
- Bettina Gaus (1956–2021), journalist
- Golo Mann (1909–1994), writer
- Klaus Mann (1906–1949), writer
- Eugen Roth (1895–1976), writer
- Dieter Kronzucker (born 1936), journalist
- Maria von Welser (born 1946), journalist
- Steffen Seibert (born 1960), journalist
- Sandra Maischberger (born 1966), journalist
- Angie Westhoff (born 1965), children's author
- Marcel Mettelsiefen (born 1978), journalist

Nobel Prize laureates

- Eduard Buchner (1860–1917), chemist and Nobel Prize winner
- Ernst Otto Fischer (1918–2007), chemist and Nobel Prize winner
- Robert Huber (born 1937), chemist and Nobel Prize winner
- Wassily Leontief (1905–1999), economist and Nobel Prize winner
- Feodor Felix Konrad Lynen (1911–1979), biochemist and Nobel Prize winner
- Rudolf Mössbauer (1929–2011), physicist and Nobel Prize winner
- Arno Allan Penzias (1933–2024), physicist and Nobel Prize winner

Notable residents

- Max Emanuel Ainmiller (1807–1870), painter
- Pope Benedict XVI, born Joseph Ratzinger, former Archbishop of Munich-Freising
- Gudrun Burwitz (1929–2018), daughter of Heinrich Himmler
- Carmela Corren, (1938–2022), Israeli singer and actress
- Manfred Eicher, record producer and founder of ECM Records
- Albert Einstein (1879–1955), Nobel Prize-winning physicist, grew up in Munich
- Hans Magnus Enzensberger (1929–2022), author
- Rainer Werner Fassbinder (1945–1982), film director
- Roger C. Field, inventor, industrial designer
- Joseph von Fraunhofer, optician
- Jeannette zu Fürstenberg (b. 1982), businesswoman and entrepreneur
- Giorgio Moroder, composer, songwriter, and record producer
- Gerd Müller (1945–2021), footballer
- Amalie Nacken (1855–1940), philanthropist
- David Dalhoff Neal, painter
- William of Ockham, English medieval philosopher
- Georg Ohm, physicist
- Marsilius of Padua, Italian medieval scholar
- Max Planck, Nobel Prize-winning physicist
- Lucia Popp, Slovak-born opera singer
- Ludwig Prandtl, father of modern aerodynamics
- Robert Hermann Raudner (1854–1915), landscape and genre painter, and etcher, lived and died at Schleißheim, and trained at the Royal Academy of Fine Arts^[215]
- Max Reger, composer, organist, pianist and conductor

Jets

- Frank Shorter (born 1947), champion distance runner

Others

- Andreas Baader (1943–1977), Red Army Faction leader
- Eva Braun, (1912–1945), Adolf Hitler's mistress and later wife
- Friedrich Brugger (1815–1870), sculptor
- Abraham Fraenkel (1891–1965), mathematician
- Uta Fritze-von Alvensleben (born 1955) — Astrophysicist
- Franz Xaver Gabelsberger (1789–1849), inventor of the Gabelsberger shorthand writing system
- Jean Baptiste Holzmayer (1839–1890), teacher, archaeologist and folklorist
- Traudl Humps (1920–2002), Adolf Hitler's personal secretary during the Second World War
- Wolfgang Franz von Kobell (1803–1882), mineralogist and writer
- Carl Alexander von Martius (1838–1920), chemist, company founder and entrepreneur
- E. Lee Spence (born 1947), pioneer underwater archaeologist and shipwreck historian
- Andrea Wolf (1965–1998), activist and militant
- Vera F. Birkenbihl (1946–2011), facilitator and non-fiction writer

- Alice Halicka, painter
- Asger Hamerik, composer
- Werner Heisenberg, Nobel Prize-winning physicist
- Adolf Hitler, German politician and leader of the Nazi Party
- Brigitte Horney, actress (Münchhausen)
- Muhammad Iqbal, Pakistan's poet, who received his PhD from Munich in 1907
- Wassily Kandinsky (1866–1944), painter
- Erich Kästner, author
- Erich Kästner (camera designer), movie camera designer, chief designer at ARRI
- Blake R. Van Leer, United States Army officer, civil rights leader and president of Georgia Institute of Technology
- Orlande de Lassus, composer
- Franz von Lenbach, painter
- Vladimir Lenin, Russian revolutionary
- Justus von Liebig, chemist
- Ernst Mach, physicist and philosopher
- Sepp Maier (born 1944), football goalkeeper
- Thomas Mann (1875–1955), Nobel Prize-winning author
- Franz M. Matschinsky (1931–2022), physician, pharmacologist and biochemist
- Helene Mayer, fencer
- Freddie Mercury, lead singer of Queen
- Wilhelm Emil "Willy" Messerschmitt, German aircraft designer and manufacturer
- Lola Montez, courtesan to King Ludwig I
- Hans and Sophie Scholl, members and activists of the White Rose resistance whilst studying at the Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität München.
- Wilhelm Röntgen, Nobel Prize-winning physicist
- Hannes Rosenow, painter
- Christopher Ross (1931–2023), sculptor, designer and collector
- Willibald Sauerländer, art historian
- Max Schreck, actor
- Arnold Schwarzenegger, former Governor of California, bodybuilder and actor, resided at Christophstr. 1 and worked at Rolf Putziger's gym at Schillerstr. 36 from 1966 to 1968
- Bastian Schweinsteiger, footballer
- Joseph Karl Stieler (1781–1858), royal court painter
- Alexander Strähuber or Straehuber (1814–1882), Austrian-born German history painter and book illustrator.
- Franz von Stuck, painter and sculptor
- Donna Summer (1948–2012), singer, known as the "Queen of Disco", she was the most successful musical artist of the Disco era in the late 1970s and early 1980s
- Vardges Sureniants, Armenian painter
- Fyodor Tyutchev, Russian Romantic poet
- Richard Wagner (1813–1883), composer
- Franz Widmann (1846–1910), painter and graphic artist, was a professor at the Royal School of Applied Arts in Munich.^[216]
- Heinrich Otto Wieland, Nobel Prize-winning chemist who successfully protected Jewish people
- Stepan Bandera, Ukrainian nationalist, assassinated in October 1959

Notes

- a. English: /ˈmjuːnɪk/ [ⓘ] *MEW-nik*
- b. It is a local party, founded in 1989 to support the queer community. It is represented in some Munich borough councils since 1990 (with its stronghold in the borough of Ludwigsvorstadt-Isarvorstadt) and in the city council continuously since 1996.

References

1. "Gemeinden, Kreise und Regierungsbezirke in Bayern, Einwohnerzahlen am 31. Dezember 2024; Basis Zensus 2022" (https://www.statistik.bayern.de/mam/produkte/veroeffentlichungen/statistische_berichte/a1210c_202400.pdf) [Municipalities, counties, and administrative districts in Bavaria; Based on the 2022 Census] (CSV) (in German). Bayerisches Landesamt für Statistik.
2. "Daten und Fakten aus der Metropolregion München" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190620161149/http://www.metropolregion-muenchen.eu/metropolregion-muenchen/daten-und-fakten-der-metropolregion-muenchen/>) [Data and facts about the Munich Metropolitan Region]. *Europäische Metropolregion München*